MIL-S-83253B(USAF)
4 February 1975
SUPERSEDING
MIL-S-83253A(USAF)
27 June 1973

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SHIRT, UTILITY (DURABLE PRESS)

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers one type of woman's shirt furnished in the following sizes as specified (see 6.2).

Short	Regular	Long
6	6	6
8	8	8
10	10	10
12	12	12
14	14	14
16	16	16
18	18	18
	20	

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

V-B-871	Button, Sewing Hole, and Button, Staple (Plastic)
V-T-276	Thread, Cotton
DDD-L-20	Label; for Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage, (General Use)
PPP-B-676	Boxes, Setup

Military

MIL-B-17757	Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated (Modular Sizes)
MIL-T-43548	Thread, Polyester, Cotton-Covered
MIL-C-83314	Cloth, Broadcloth, Polyester/Cotton (Durable Press)

FSC 8410

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STANDARDS

Federal

FED-STD-751 Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

Military

MIL-STD-105 Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Department of Defense (DOD) Standard Shades for Buttons 1966

DOD Standard Color Card of Official Standardized Shades for Sewing Threads 1968

(Copies of these publications may be obtained from the Color Association of the United States, Inc., 200 Madison Ave., New York, New York 10016.)

Technical Manual of the American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists (AATCC)

(Copies of this manual may be obtained from the American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists, Research Triangle Park, Post Office Box 886, Durham, North Carolina 27702.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries and are also distributed among technical groups and using federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Guide samples. Guide samples of the shirt, if furnished (see 6.3), are solely for information. In the event of conflict between the guide sample and the text of this specification, the text of this specification shall apply.

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3.2 Materials

* 3.2.1 Basic fabric. The basic fabric of the shirt shall conform to MIL-C-83314. The color of the basic fabric shall be blue conforming to USAF color shade No. 1550 (see 6.3).

3.2.2 Buttons. The buttons for the front closure shall conform to type II, class K, style 25, sizes 16 and 19 lines of V-B-871. The color of the buttons shall be DOD Button Shade White BA, cable No. 62031 (see DOD Standard Shades for Buttons 1966).

* 3.2.3 Thread. Unless otherwise specified herein, the thread used for all sewing shall conform to ticket No. 70, 2 ply of MIL-T-43548. As an option thread conforming to type IA2, ticket No. 40, 6 ply of V-T-276 may be used for the buttonholes. The thread used for all blindstitching shall be a clear polyester monofilament thread having a melting point of not less than 485 degrees Fahrenheit and conforming to HTG Sew Klear (R) size No. 10, or equal, manufactured by the Synthetic Thread Co. Inc., 825 Twelfth Avenue, Bethlehem, Pennsylvania (see 4.2). Except for the thread used for blindstitching, the thread used for all stitching shall be DOD Thread Shade Light Blue 0, cable No. 66029 (see DOD Standard Color Card of Official Standardized Shades for Sewing Thread 1968). The dyed thread shall have colorfastness to light and combined laundering and bleaching equal to or better than the standard sample. If a standard sample is not available, the dyed thread shall have good colorfastness to light and combined laundering and bleaching.

3.3 Design. The shirt shall have a plain front, 8-button closure, with a button loop for the top button, rounded collar, open bottom, back yoke, sleeves, and notched hem at the side seams. The bottom of the shirt is intended to be worn on the outside of a skirt or pair of slacks.

3.4 Construction. The shirt shall be constructed in accordance with table I; however, the manufacturer is not required to follow the exact sequence of operations as listed therein, unless otherwise specified. Any additional basting or holding stitching may be used, provided the thread is removed or does not show on the finished shirt.

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TABLE I. Sewing Operations

No.	Description of Operation	Stitch Type	Seam and Stitching Type	Stitches Per Inch
1	Cut parts (a) The cloth shall be carefully laid up in uniform lengths and widths where possible. Take care in spreading the material so that plies are not stretched or full and so that one side of the lay is even. (b) Cut the parts of the shirt in strict accordance with the patterns which show size, shape and warp directional line for pattern lay, and notches for proper assembling of all parts. Except for the parts that may be cut from ends, cut all parts of the shirt from one piece of cloth. The undercollar, the collar interlining, the button reinforcement piece, and the inner yoke may be cut from ends. If the undercollar is cut from ends, it shall approximate the shade of the other parts of the shirt. (c) Mark each part in the top ply of the main lay with the size of the shirt.			
2	Replace defective or damaged parts (a) Replace at the time of cutting any part containing holes or seriously weakening defects such as smashes, multiple floats, or slubs. (b) Replace any part damaged during the manufacturing process by scissor or knife cut, needle chews, tears, holes, mends, burns, or drill holes.			

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TABLE I. Sewing Operations (Cont)

No.	Description of Operation	Stitch Type	Seam and Stitching Type	Stitches Per Inch
3	Shade mark			
	(a) Mark or ticket all parts to insure a uniform shade throughout the shirt and the proper assembling of all parts. If shade marking is used, the marking shall not show through and be visible on the outside of the shirt.			
4	Make collar			
	(a) Join the outer edges of the topcollar, the undercollar, and the interlining with a 1/4-inch seam. Trim the seam allowance to 1/8 inch at the curved edge; turn, and work out the edges so that the seam line is at the edge and the underside is not exposed from the top side and the rounded corners. The undercollar shall not be exposed beyond the edge of the topcollar, and the corners shall be uniform in shape. Edge stitch the collar 1/16 to 1/8 inch from the edge.	301 301	SSa-1 SSe-2(b)	10-14 10-14
*	(b) Stamp the size of the shirt on the topcollar with the marking centered on the topcollar approximately 3/4 inch from its inner edge.			
5	Make bust darts			
	(a) Fold and stitch the bust darts on the fronts, below the armhole, tapering to nothing 5/8 inch beyond the drill hole. The darts shall finish on the inside, with the folded edge toward the bottom of the shirt.	301	OSf-1	10-14
	(b) Press the bust darts smooth and flat toward the bottom of the shirt on the inside with a heated pressing iron.			

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TABLE I. Sewing Operations (Cont)

No.	Description of Operation	Stitch Type	Seam and Stitching Type	Stitches Per Inch
6	Attach yoke to back			
	(a) Position the two plies of the yoke, inserting the back, and stitch 3/8 inch from the edge.	301 or 401	SSa-1	10-14
7	Overedge stitch bottom			
	(a) Overedge stitch the bottom raw edges of the fronts and the back.	503 or 504	EFd-1	9-11
8	Join shoulder seam			
	(a) Position the plies of the yoke, inserting the fronts, and stitch 3/8 inch from the edge. The stitching shall not show on the outside of the shirt.	301 or 401	SSa-1	10-14
9	Attach or apply labels			
*	(a) Position the center of the instruction label approximately 3-1/2 inches upward from the finished bottom of the shirt with the top edge parallel and adjacent to the back edge of the left front facing, and sew the instruction label on all four sides to the facing part only. The stitching shall be 1/8-inch gage from the edge of the instruction label.	301	LSbj-1	8-12
*	(b) Apply the marking of the combination identification and size label within 3 to 6 inches upward from the finished bottom of the shirt, centered vertically, with the top edge parallel to the back edge of the right front facing.			
10	Hem and join facings to fronts			
	(a) Turn back the edge of the facing with the raw edges turned in, and stitch through the facing. The finished hem	301	EFb-1	10-12

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TABLE I. Sewing Operations (Cont)

No.	Description of Operation	Stitch Type	Seam and Stitching Type	Stitches Per Inch
	shall be 3/16 to 1/4 inch wide.			
	(b) Join the facings to the front edges of shirt, catching the button reinforcement on the left front in the stitching, with a 3/8-inch seam. Continue the stitching across the bottom of the facing, in line with the hem fold line indicated on the patterns, to the back edge of the facing. Trim the corners.	301	SSa-1	10-14
11	Set collar to shirt			
	(a) With the facings on the outside of the fronts, insert the ends of the collar between the fronts and the facings with the ends of the collar at the facing joining seam line; stitch from the front seam to the shoulder seam with a 3/8-inch seam. The top edge of the facing shall be folded under 1/4 inch. Notch all plies at the shoulder seam on both sides of the neck line, and stitch the remaining part of the undercollar to the neck edge across the back with a 3/8-inch seam.	301	SSa-1 and LScf-2(a)	10-14
	(b) Turn the facings to the inside. Work out the corners and the bottom edge so that the seam line is at the edge and the underside is not exposed on the outside. Turn under the unsewn portion of the topcollar, and stitch 1/16 to 1/8 inch from the folded edge of the topcollar through the undercollar joining seam allowance and the undercollar.	301	LScf-2(b)	10-14
	(c) Stitch the folded top edge of the facing to the front at the shoulder seam.	301	LSd-1	10-14

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TABLE I. Sewing Operations (Cont)

No.	Description of Operation	Stitch Type	Seam and Stitching Type	Stitches Per Inch
12	Join sleeves to armholes			
	(a) Seam the sleeves to the armholes with a 3/8-inch seam, matching the notches as indicated on the patterns, with the fullness at the sleeve head worked in evenly.	301	SSa-1	10-14
	(b) Overedge stitch the raw edges together.	503 or 504	EFd-1	9-11
	OR			
	(c) The seam joining the armholes and the sleeves may be stitched and the edge of the seam allowance finished in one operation.	515 or 516 or 517 or 518	SSa-2	10-14
13	Join side and sleeve seams			
*	(a) Join the sleeve seam and the side seam continuously, forming a 1-3/4-inch-notch opening in the bottom hem. The ends of the armhole seam shall be turned against the sleeve. The armhole seam line on the front and the back at the side seam shall be aligned.			
	(b) Fold the hem of the front face to face in accordance with the notches, and stitch with a 3/8-inch seam allowance from the folded edge up to the first notch; continue stitching across the seam to the raw edge. Clip the seam allowance diagonally upward to the stitched corners; turn, and force out the corners and the edges.	301	SSa-1	10-14
	(c) Fold up the back bottom hem face to face according to the notches; join the back to the front and the sleeve seam with a 3/8-inch seam to the bottom folded edge of the back	301	SSa-1	10-14

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TABLE I. Sewing Operations (Cont)

No.	Description of Operation	Stitch Type	Seam and Stitching Type	Stitches Per Inch
	catching the top of the front hem in the stitching, forming a slit opening at the bottom.			
	(d) Overedge stitch the raw edges together.	503 or 504	EFd-1	9-11
	OR			
	(e) The sleeve seam and the side seam may be stitched and edge of the seam allowance finished continuously in one operation. The ends of the armhole seam shall be turned against the sleeve. The ends of the armhole seam line at the side seam line shall be aligned.	515 or 516 or 517 or 518	SSa-2	10-14
	(f) Turn the hem to the underside, forcing out the corners and the seam line to the edge at the sides of the hem notch. Press the side and sleeve seams flat toward the back above the bottom notch with a heated pressing iron.			
	NOTE: No. 13 shall be performed prior to No. 14.			
14	Hem sleeves			
	(a) Turn up the bottom of the sleeve as indicated by the notches on the pattern, with the raw edge turned in 1/2 inch; blindstitch 1/16 inch from the top edge, through the sleeve, forming a hem 5-3/4 inches (plus or minus 1/8 inch) wide, with the sleeve seam turned toward the back.	301 or 103 or 306	EFb-1	6-8
* 15	Hem bottom of shirt			
*	(a) Turn up the bottom of the shirt as indicated by the notches on the pattern; blindstitch at the top edge, forming a hem 2-3/8 inches (plus or minus 1/8 inch) wide with the	103 or 301 or 306	EF1-1	6-8

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TABLE I. Sewing Operations (Cont)

No.	Description of Operation	Stitch Type	Seam and Stitching Type	Stitches Per Inch
	side seams toward the back. Continue the blindstitching of the hem across the front facings 1 inch to 1-1/2 inches.			
16	Make buttonholes			
	(a) Locate and make five vertical and two horizontal, straight, cut, purl type buttonholes barred at each end in accordance with the marks on the patterns. The vertical buttonhole openings shall be 9/16 inch (plus or minus 1/16 inch) from the front edge. The forward end of the horizontal buttonholes shall be 1/2 to 5/8 inch from the front edge. The buttonhole openings shall be 11/16 inch (plus or minus 1/16 inch) in length. The purl side of the buttonhole shall be on the outside of the shirt. The center of the top buttonhole shall be 4 inches (plus or minus 1/8 inch) from the collar joining seam line.	304		52 stitches per buttonhole including bartacks
17	Make button loop			
	(a) Make a chain button loop along the front-front facing joining seam line, beginning at the collar joining seam line and ending 1/2 inch (plus or minus 1/16 inch) below the collar joining seam line. The length of the button loop shall be 1/2 inch (plus or minus 1/16 inch). The thread end of the button loop shall be securely tacked off.	hand		
18	Sew on buttons			
	(a) Sew five 19-line buttons on the left front, with the centers of the buttons 5/8 to 3/4 inch from the front edge, through the left front facing. The buttons shall be securely sewn and aligned with the centers of the five corresponding vertical buttonholes and aligned with the forward end of the two lower buttonholes in the front of the shirt.	301 or 101		14-16 stitches per button 20-24 stitches per button

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TABLE I. Sewing Operations (Cont)

No.	Description of Operation	Stitch Type	Seam and Stitching Type	Stitches Per Inch
	(b) Sew two 19-line buttons on the left front, with the centers of the buttons 5/8 to 3/4 inch from the front edge, through the front facing. The buttons shall be securely sewn and aligned horizontally to correspond with the two lower buttonholes.	301 or 101		14-16 stitches per button 20-24 stitches per button
*	(c) Sew one 16-line button 3/8 to 1/2 inch from the front edge, at the neck opening on the left front, corresponding with the chain button loop. The thread shall not be exposed on the facing side of the shirt.	301 or 101 or hand		14-16 stitches per button 20-24 stitches per button 2 double stitches per sewing hole with double tack end of sewing
19	Clean shirt (a) Trim all end of threads, and remove loose threads from the shirt. Remove all spots or stains and shade tickets from the shirt.			
20	Press shirt (a) Press the shirt with a hot head pressing machine as follows: (1) After the collar is fabricated but before the collar is joined to shirt, press the collar.			

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TABLE I. Sewing Operations (Cont)

No.	Description of Operation	Stitch Type	Seam and Stitching Type	Stitches Per Inch
	(2) Before sewing the darts and before the fronts are joined to the back, press both finished fronts.			
*	(3) After the yoke is attached to the back but before the back is joined to the fronts, press the back and the yoke. Take care, during the pressing, so that the yoke and the back will be lying as flat as possible.			
	(b) As an option to No. 20(a)(2) and 20(a)(3), the entire shirt may be pressed after fabrication with a Formatic hot head pressing machine, or equal, which is capable of pressing the entire finished shirt. (Formatic hot head pressing machines are manufactured by the American Laundry Machinery Co., Cincinnati, Ohio.)			
	(c) Press the shirt with a heated iron at a permanent press (moderate) setting as follows:			
	(1) Press the underarm seams, the side seams, the armholes, the bust darts, the bottom hem, the sleeve hems, and the front edges.			
*	(2) Touch-up the shirt before folding it for packaging Note: A steam-inflated-bag type of pressing machine shall not be used to press the shirt. The hot head pressing machine specified herein shall be a hot head pressing machine that is equipped with controls for accurate temperature (350 - 370 degrees Fahrenheit), time (minimum of 10 seconds, with 3 seconds for steam and 7 seconds for bake and vacuum), and pressure.			
*	21 Button and fold			
	(a) Button all the buttons of the shirt. Fold the shirt neatly.			

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3.4.1 Stitches, seams, and stitchings. Stitch, seam, and stitching types shall conform to FED-STD-751. The stitches per inch specified in table I shall be interpreted to be the minimum and the maximum permitted. Wherever two or more methods of seams or stitchings are given for the same part of an operation, any one of them may be used. The looper (under thread) of stitch type 401 shall be on the inside of the shirt. Edge stitching and top stitching shall be uniformly gaged throughout the shirt. The guides and knives on machines producing stitch types 515, 516, 517, and 518 shall be set to trim only the raveled edges of the fabric. If a knife is used on the overedging machine, only the raveled ends shall be trimmed off; the edge of the fabric shall not be cut off. The trimming shall not exceed 1/16 inch. Seam allowances shall be maintained. Seams shall be sewn so that there will be no raw edges, run-offs, twists, pleats, or puckers. The following practices to avoid puckering and to produce the flattest seams possible shall be given consideration by the manufacturer of the shirt. The needle should be the smallest size possible with a slim point. The smallest throat plate hole possible should be used to prevent flagging. Pressure on the presser foot should be just enough to insure a steady flow of material. The feed dogs should contain 18 to 20 teeth per inch for normal sewing and 20 to 25 teeth per inch for stitching down. All attachments should be as smooth as possible to permit free flowing of the material through the machine. The lightest possible thread tensions, while maintaining a good stitch, should be used. The upper and lower threads shall be balanced. Checks to insure that blunt needles are eliminated and that machine adjustments are maintained should be made frequently.

3.4.1.1 Thread breaks and ends of seams. If not caught in other seams or stitching, the ends of all seams and stitching produced with stitch type 301 shall be backtacked not less than 1/4 inch. Thread breaks (all stitch types) shall be secured by stitching back of break not less than 1/2 inch. The ends of a continuous row of stitching shall be overlapped not less than 1/2 inch.

* 3.4.2 Shade and size marking. The parts of the shirts shall be marked, ticketed, or bundled to insure accurate assembly and a uniform shade and size throughout the shirt. Marking may be any method except adhesive-type tickets that will discolor the material or will leave traces of paper or adhesive on the material after the tickets are removed, corrosive metal fastening devices, or sew-on tickets. The size of the shirt may be stamped on the topcollar with the marking centered on the topcollar approximately 3/4 inch from its inner edge.

3.5 Patterns. When specified by the procuring activity (see 6.2), standard patterns will be furnished by the Government. Unless otherwise indicated, the standard patterns will provide an allowance of 3/8 inch for all joining seams except that an allowance of 1/4 inch will be provided for making the collar. The standard patterns shall not be altered in any way. The standard patterns are to be used only as a guide for making the supplier's working patterns which shall be identical to the standard patterns.

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3.5.1 Pattern parts. The shirt shall be cut from the materials and in accordance with the pattern parts specified in table II.

* TABLE II. Pattern Parts

Materials	Pattern Parts	Parts Cut
Basic material (see 3.2.1)	Front	2
	Yoke	2
	Back	1
	Sleeve	2
*	Collar 1/	3
	Front facing	2
	Button reinforcement	1

* 1/ The same pattern part is used for the topcollar, the undercollar, and the collar interlining.

* 3.6 Label. Each shirt shall have a combination identification and size label and an instruction label. All the labels shall have colorfastness to laundering as specified in DDD-L-20. The combination identification and size label shall conform to type IV, classes 1 and 2 of DDD-L-20. The instruction label shall be 2 inches long and 2-1/4 inches wide and shall conform to type I, class 3 of DDD-L-20 except that the instruction label shall not contain the item description. The instruction label shall contain the following information:

1. For machine washing, use wash and wear cycle. Wash with moderately hot water (120° F), using soap or mild detergent.

2. For hand washing, wash in moderately hot water (120° F), using soap or mild detergent. Do NOT wring or twist.

3. Dry in tumble dryer at hot setting. Remove immediately at end of drying. Shape and hang.

4. To drip dry, remove from water before last spin cycle. Shape and hang.

5. If touch up is required, iron at a moderate heat setting.

DO NOT REMOVE THIS LABEL.

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* 3.7 Finished measurements. The finished measurements of the shirt shall conform to table III. The finished measurements shall be taken as follows: Take the measurement of the 1/2 bust, with the shirt buttoned, from folded edge to folded edge at the base of the armhole. Take the measurement of the back length, at the center back, from the collar seam line to the bottom of the shirt. Take the measurement of the sleeve seam, along the sleeve seam, from the armhole seam line to the bottom of the sleeve. Take the measurement of the collar, end to end, along the neck seam line.

TABLE III. Finished Measurements

Size of Shirt	Finished Measurements in Inches 1/			
	1/2 Bust (± 3/8)	Back Length (± 1/4)	Sleeve Seam (± 1/4)	Collar (± 1/4)
Short				
6	19	20	9-3/8	13
8	20	20-1/4	9-1/2	13-1/2
10	20-1/2	20-1/2	9-5/8	14
12	21	20-3/4	9-3/4	14-1/2
14	21-3/4	21	9-7/8	15
16	22-1/2	21-1/4	10	15-1/2
18	23-1/4	21-1/2	10-1/8	16
Regular				
6	19	21	9-5/8	13
8	20	21-1/4	9-3/4	13-1/2
10	20-1/2	21-1/2	9-7/8	14
12	21	21-3/4	10	14-1/2
14	21-3/4	22	10-1/8	15
16	22-1/2	22-1/4	10-1/4	15-1/2
18	23-1/4	22-1/2	10-3/8	16
20	24-1/4	22-3/4	10-1/2	16-1/2
Long				
6	19	22	9-7/8	13
8	20	22-1/4	10	13-1/2
10	20-1/2	22-1/2	10-1/8	14
12	21	22-3/4	10-1/4	14-1/2
14	21-3/4	23	10-3/8	15
16	22-1/2	23-1/4	10-1/2	15-1/2
18	23-1/4	23-1/2	10-5/8	16

* 1/ The finished measurements shall be taken as specified in 3.7.

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* 3.8 End item appearance. After the finished shirt has been laundered five times, the average seam and stitching appearance rating of the shirt shall be not less than 3.5 for the following stitched areas: collar, shoulder, yoke, armholes, bust darts, bottom hem, front edge, and underarm and side seams. The seam and stitching appearance rating of each of these stitched areas shall be not less than 3.0.

3.9 Workmanship. The shirt shall be manufactured in a thoroughly workmanlike manner.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection for acceptance. Unless otherwise specified herein, inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. If a certificate of compliance is submitted for any requirements specified herein (see 3.2.3), the Government will reserve the right to check test the item covered by the certificate of compliance to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2.1 Examination of end item. The end item shall be examined as specified in 4.2.1.1 and 4.2.1.2. The sample unit for these examinations shall be one shirt.

* 4.2.1.1 Visual examination. The end item shall be visually examined for defects. Except for the defects with an asterisk in the classification column, the defects found during this visual examination shall be classified as specified in tables IV and V. Except as otherwise specified for material defects and workmanship damages, the defects with an asterisk in the classification column shall be classified as major defects if the defects seriously affect appearance or serviceability and as minor A defects if the defects affect appearance or serviceability but not seriously. The inspection level for this visual examination shall be III of MIL-STD-105. The acceptable quality level for this visual examination shall be 1.5 defects per 100 units (dhu) for major defects, 6.5 dhu for major and minor A (combined) defects, and 15.0 dhu for total (major and minor A and B combined) defects.

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TABLE IV. General Defects

Defect	Major	Minor A	Minor B
Material defects and workmanship damages 1/			
Any hole or weakening defect such as smash, multiple float, or loose slub that might develop into hole		*	
Scissor or knife cut, tear, mend, burn, or needle chew that might develop into hole		*	
Shade bar, unsightly slub, dye or finishing streak, or any other material defects		*	
Shaded parts			
* Any part required to be cut from one piece of material shaded		X	
* Variation of shade within outside part			X
Cleanness			
* Grease, ink, or oil with dirt on outside up to 3/8 inch inclusive (largest dimension in any direction)			X
* Grease, ink, or oil with dirt on outside more than 3/8 inch (largest dimension in any direction)		*	
* Spot or stain (including oil without dirt but not including grease, ink, or oil with dirt) on outside more than 1/2 inch (largest dimension in any direction)			X
* Spot or stain on inside more than 1/2 inch (largest dimension in any direction) and clearly visible on outside			X
* Two or more shade tickets or loose thread ends not removed throughout shirt			X
* Five or more thread ends on outside not trimmed			X

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TABLE IV. General Defects (Cont)

	Defect	Major	Minor A	Minor B
	Component and assembly			
*	Any component defective (unless otherwise classified herein)	*		
*	Any component omitted (unless otherwise classified herein)	*		
*	Any required operation omitted or not performed as specified (unless otherwise classified herein)	*		
	Cutting			
	Any part not cut in accordance with warp directional lines on patterns or specification requirements	X		
*	Seams and stitchings			
	Any part of shirt caught in unrelated operation or stitching	*		
*	Seams twisted, puckered, or pleated seriously affecting appearance (unless otherwise classified herein)		X	
	Ends of seams and stitchings (stitch type 301), when not caught in other seams or stitching, not backtacked as specified or thread breaks not secured by stitching back of break as specified		X	
	Shade(s) of thread used on outside (collar) not satisfactorily matching shade of shirt	*		
	Gage of stitching on edge or raise stitching irregular i.e., unevenly gaged or corresponding stitching not uniformly gaged, affecting appearance		X	
	Gage of stitching on edge or raise stitching or turned in stitchings not within the range specified or varying more than 1/16 inch if range is not specified			X
	Open seam on joining seam more than 1/8 inch but not more than 1/4 inch 2/			X

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TABLE IV. General Defects (Cont)

Defect	Major	Minor A	Minor B
Open seam on joining seam more than 1/4 inch but not more than 1 inch 2/		X	
Open seam on joining seam more than 1 inch 2/	X		
Open seam on sleeve or facing more than 1/4 inch 2/			X
Open seam on blindstitching of bottom hem or sleeve hems more than 3/4 inch 2/			X
Raw edge on outside more than 1/8 inch but not more than 1/4 inch 3/			X
Raw edge on outside more than 1/4 inch but not more than 3/4 inch 3/		X	
Raw edge on outside more than 3/4 inch 3/	X		
Raw edge on inside exclusive of overedged edges more than 1/2 inch but not more than 2 inches 3/			X
Raw edge on inside exclusive of overedge edges more than 2 inches 3/		X	
Raw edge on overedged edge more than 1 inch but not more than 3 inches except bottom edge 3/			X
Raw edge on overedged edge more than 3 inches except bottom edge 3/		X	
Run-offs on raise, top, or edge stitching if not resulting in open seam (outside only) more than 1/2 inch but not more than 1 inch 4/			X
Run-offs on raise, top, or edge stitching if not resulting in open seam (outside only) more than 1 inch 4/		X	
Not specified seam type		X	
Not specified stitch type		X	
Loose tension resulting in loose seam	X		

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TABLE IV. General Defects (Cont)

Defect	Major	Minor A	Minor B
Loose tension on raise, top, or edge stitching, i.e., loosely exposed loops of lower or top thread		X	
Tight tension (stitches break when normal strain is applied to seam or stitching) 5/	X		
Stitches per inch one stitch less than specified minimum on seams, except stitching of labels or seams that are later raised, top, or edge stitched 6/			X
Stitches per inch two stitches less than specified minimum on seams, except stitching of labels or seams that are later raised, top, or edge stitched 6/		X	
Stitches per inch three or more stitches less than specified minimum on seams except stitching of labels or seams that are later raised, top, or edge stitched 6/	X		
Stitches per inch two or more stitches less than specified minimum on stitching of labels or seams that are later raised, top, or edge stitched 6/			X
* Two or more stitches in excess of maximum stitches per inch specified 6/			X
Stitches skipped or broken 1/4 inch or more but not more than 1/2 inch on raise, top, or edge stitching if stitching is not joining seam			X
Stitches skipped or broken more than 1/2 inch on raise, top, or edge stitching if stitching is not joining seam		X	
Buttonholes (construction)			
Buttonhole stitching not securely caught in fabric, causing stitching to pull away from fabric	X		
More than two skipped stitches in one or more buttonholes		X	
One or more broken stitches in one buttonhole		X	
One or more broken stitches in two or more buttonholes	X		

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TABLE IV. General Defects (Cont)

	Defect	Major	Minor A	Minor B
*	Bartack of one buttonhole missing, loose, or misplaced (not serving intended purpose)			X
*	Bartack of two or more buttonholes missing, loose, or misplaced (not serving intended purpose)		X	
	Very ragged edges on buttonhole(s), incomplete stitching on buttonhole(s), or uncut buttonhole(s)		X	
	Not specified type of buttonhole		X	
	Buttonhole(s) poorly constructed (unless otherwise classified herein)		X	
	Buttonhole(s) not corresponding to size of button(s) so that they do not button properly		X	
	Purl side of buttonhole not on outside of shirt			X
	Buttons			
	One button missing, insecurely sewn, or broken or defective			X
	Two or more buttons missing, insecurely sewn, or broken or defective		X	
	Any button not specified color, type, style, or size		X	

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TABLE IV. General Defects (Cont)

Defect	Major	Minor A	Minor B
Pressing			
Shirt burned or scorched	X		
Pressing omitted	X		
Shirt poorly pressed or partly pressed 7/		X	

1/ If the condition of the material defect is nonweakening, is inconspicuous, and has a negligible effect on serviceability, the material defect shall not be classified as a defect. If the condition of the workmanship damage is nonweakening, is inconspicuous, and has a neglegible effect on serviceability, the workmanship damage shall be classified as a minor B defect. If the condition of the material defect or workmanship damage is weakening or is conspicuously located so that it is clearly noticeable, the material defect and workmanship damage shall be classified as indicated herein.
2/ A break in a line of stitching or continuous skipped or run-off stitches, except on edge or raise stitching, shall constitute an open seam.
3/ A raw edge shall be classified as such if overedging is omitted where required or if it occurs along an edge required to be turned under but the edge is securely caught in the stitching. If the edge is not securely caught in the stitching, the condition shall be classified as an open seam.
4/ Run-offs on joining seams, if resulting in an open seam, shall be classified as open seams.
5/ Puckering is evidence of tight tension. If puckering is evident, the seam shall be tested by exerting normal pull in the lengthwise direction of the seam or stitching.
6/ Defects applicable to stitches per inch shall not be classified as defects unless the condition exists on the major portion of the seam.
7/ Wrinkles or creases caused by packaging shall not be classified as a defect.

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TABLE V. Detailed Defects Applicable to Specific Parts

Defect	Major	Minor A	Minor B
OUTSIDE OF SHIRT			
Collar			
Topcollar twisted or tight, causing edges to curl up	*		
Collar edges crooked, affecting appearance		X	
Rounded ends poorly shaped or not uniform shape affecting appearance	*		
Collar edges not properly force out, i.e., seam line not forced out to edge having folds 1/16 inch or more deep, undercollar exposed along edge for distance of more than 1 inch, or points along curved edge			X
Short, i.e., causing puckers on front(s) or back	*		
Long, i.e., causing puckers on topcollar or undercollar	*		
Collar not centered by more than 1/4 inch when shoulder seams at neck line are aligned		X	
Edge stitch on collar omitted		X	
End of collar at neck seam line more than 1/8 inch back from finished front edge		X	
Front closure			
Buttons and buttonholes out of alignment causing noticeable bulge on fronts when buttoned, affecting appearance	*		
Length of fronts when buttoned uneven at neck by more than 1/8 inch or at bottom by 1/8 inch or more		X	
Front edge not forced out, i.e., seam line not forced out to the edge having folds 1/16 inch or more deep or underside exposed along front edge for distance of more than 1 inch			X

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TABLE V. Detailed Defects Applicable to Specific Parts (Cont)

	Defect	Major	Minor A	Minor B
	Bottom corner or bottom edge not forced out, i.e., seam line not forced out to edge, having folds 1/16 inch or more deep, or facing exposed below bottom edge of front		X	
	One or more vertical buttonholes on right front more than 1/8 inch out of alignment		X	
*	One or more vertical buttonholes less than 1/2 inch or more than 5/8 inch from finished front edge			X
	Center of top buttonhole from finished collar joining seam line less than 3-3/4 inches or more than 4-1/4 inches		X	
	Length of unbuttoned fronts uneven by more than 1/4 inch			X
	Cut length of buttonhole less than 5/8 inch or more than 3/4 inch			X
	Button reinforcement short or twisted, causing noticeable bulge or fullness on front, affecting appearance			X
	Seven lower buttons more than 1/8 inch out of alignment			X
	One or more lower buttons less than 5/8 inch or more than 3/4 inch from front edge			X
	Forward end of front lower horizontal buttonhole(s) less than 1/2 inch or more than 5/8 inch from front edge			X
*	Top 16-line loop button less than 3/8 inch or more than 1/2 inch from front edge			X
	Space between vertical buttonholes uneven 1/4 inch or more			X
	Stitching thread of top 16-line loop button caught on facing		X	
	Stitching thread of one or more front buttons not caught on facing		X	

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TABLE V. Detailed Defects Applicable to Specific Parts (Cont)

Defect	Major	Minor A	Minor B
Button loop			
Button loop less than 7/16 inch or more than 9/16 inch long			X
* Button loop missing or insecure		X	
Top end of loop more than 1/8 inch below collar joining seam			X
Bust darts			
Ends of bust darts not tapered to point causing unsightly bulge			X
Dart(s) at dart line or end(s) of dart(s) on outside not pressed flat			X
Darts not uniformly positioned or not equal in length affecting appearance		X	
Dart(s) not pressed toward bottom of shirt on inside			X
Armhole and sleeve			
Excessive fullness or fullness misplaced, resulting in puckers or pleats in sleeve head	*		
Sleeve tight, causing fullness or pleats on front or back	*		
Armhole irregular, i.e., crooked, affecting appearance		X	
Ends of armhole seam line at sleeve and side seam line staggered more than 1/4 inch		X	
Sleeve puckered or pleated in stitching of hem or hem twisted, puckered, or pleated, affecting outside appearance		X	
Sleeve hem less than 5-5/8 inches or more than 5-7/8 inches in width			X

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TABLE V. Detailed Defects Applicable to Specific Parts (Cont)

Defect	Major	Minor A	Minor B
Hem irregular in width by 3/16 inch or more			X
Left and right hems not uniform in width by more than 3/16 inch			X
Sleeve hem made prior to closing sleeve and side seam		X	
INSIDE SHIRT			
Facing			
Front facing twisted, puckered, or pulled at neck or shoulder affecting outside appearance		X	
Front facing full or tight between buttonholes, affecting appearance		X	
Back edge of one or both front facings short or full, affecting outside appearance		*	
Hem on back edge of facing less than 3/16 inch or more than 1/4 inch wide		X	
Gorge of front, facing, or neck edge of topcollar or undercollar not securely caught in seaming of collar to neck edge of shirt		X	
Shoulder edge of front facing not stitched to shoulder seam		X	
Stitches for loop button exposed on facing side		X	
Labels			
* Combination identification and size label not centered vertically on right front facing by more than 1/4 inch, top edge of combination identification and size label not parallel to back edge of right front facing, or any part of combination identification and size label less than 2-1/2 inches or more than 6-1/2 inches upward from finished bottom of shirt			X

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TABLE V. Detailed Defects Applicable to Specific Parts (Cont)

	Defect	Major	Minor A	Minor B
	Size on combination identification and size label omitted, incorrect, or illegible		X	
	Information on combination identification and size label other than size omitted, incorrect, or illegible			X
	Instruction label missing, incorrect, or illegible	X		
	Instruction label not positioned as specified herein			X
*	Instruction label not stitched on one or more sides			X
*	Instruction label caught through outside of shirt		X	
*	Instruction label less than 1-3/4 inches or more than 2-1/4 inches long or less than 2 inches or more than 2-1/2 inches wide			X
	Armhole seams			
	Armhole seam edges not overedged together		X	
	End(s) of armhole seam at side seam not turned against sleeve			X
	Side and sleeve seams			
	Side or sleeve seam(s) or part thereof including ends not pressed flat toward back above bottom notch			X
	One or more side or sleeve seam edges not overedged together		X	
	Ends of armhole seam allowance at side seam not caught in overedging			X
	Bottom hem			
	Bottom hem badly twisted, affecting outside appearance		X	
	Front or back puckered or pleated in blindstitching of bottom hem affecting appearance		X	

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TABLE V. Detailed Defects Applicable to Specific Parts (Cont)

Defect	Major	Minor A	Minor B
Bottom edge irregular affecting appearance		X	
Edge not overedged before blindstitching to shirt			X
Bottom hem irregular in width by 1/4 inch or more			X
Corner and edge(s) of notch opening in hem not forced out; i.e., seam line not forced out to edge having folds 1/16 inch or more deep or underside exposed along side of notch			X
Sides of notch opening in hem not equal in length by more than 1/8 inch			X
Raw edge exposed at top of notch or side of notch at top not aligned with seam line above notch by more than 1/8 inch		X	
Blindstitches at top of hem not caught to body of shirt for distance of more than 3/4 inch			X
* Bottom hem less than 2-1/4 inches or more than 2-1/2 inches wide			X

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4.2.1.2 Examination of finished measurements. The end item shall be examined for conformance to the finished measurements specified in table III. The inspection level for this examination of the finished measurements shall be S-3 of MIL-STD-105. The acceptable quality level for this examination of the finished measurements shall be 4.0 dhu for defects (one class). Any finished measurement deviating from the finished measurements specified in table III or sleeve lengths of any shirt uneven by more than 1/2 inch shall be classified as a finished measurement defect.

4.2.2 Testing of end item. The end item shall be tested, as specified in 4.4.1 and 4.4.2, to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.8. All requirements shall be applicable to the sample unit. The sample unit shall be one finished shirt. The sample size shall be as specified in table VI. One shirt shall be used to evaluate all appearance requirements. If one or more sample units fail to meet any of the specified requirements, the lot shall not be acceptable.

TABLE VI. Sample Size

Lot Size	Sample Size
800 or less	2
801 to 22,000 inclusive	3
22,001 or more	5

4.2.3 Examination of preparation for delivery. Shipping containers fully prepared for delivery shall be examined for the defects listed in table VII to determine conformance to packaging, packing, and marking requirements. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 of MIL-STD-105; the acceptable quality level shall be 2.5 dhu.

4.3 Test equipment. The washing and drying equipment, the lighting equipment, and the photographic standards for single needle stitching used for the tests and evaluations specified in 4.4.1 and 4.4.2 shall be as described in AATCC Test Method 88-B-1970 (see Technical Manual of the AATCC). The ballast specified in 4.4.1 shall consist of durable press shirts that are approximately the same weight as the test shirts or of 3-feet-square hemmed pieces of durable press fabric that is similar to the fabric of the test shirts.

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TABLE VII. Defects Applicable to Preparation for Delivery

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; or improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing
	Any component not as specified or damaged, affecting appearance
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of case liners or container flaps, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling
	Bulging or distortion of containers
	Open and noncontinuous heat-seal seams and closure of polyethylene bag
Content	Number of intermediate packages per container more or less than required
	Size shown on one or more shirts not as specified on container 1/

1/ One intermediate package from each container in the sample shall be examined for this defect.

4.4 Test methods

4.4.1 Laundering and conditioning. If the shirts selected as test samples will weigh less than 4 pounds, ballast to make up a standard 4-pound load shall be added to the test shirts. The front of each shirt in the 4-pound load shall be unbuttoned. The 4-pound load shall be placed in the washing machine. Ninety grams of AATCC Detergent 124 shall also be placed in the washing machine. The washing machine shall be set for 12 minutes on the hot wash and wear cycle, high water level. The washing machine shall be filled with water from a water source set at 140 (plus or minus 5) degrees Fahrenheit. Immediately after the washing machine has completed the final spin cycle, the entire load shall be removed, untangled, and placed in the dryer. The dryer shall be operated at a temperature of 140 to 160 degrees Fahrenheit until the entire load is dry. After the entire load has been dried,

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the entire load shall be tumbled for 5 minutes in the dryer with the heat turned off (cool-down cycle). Immediately after the tumbling is completed, the entire load shall be removed from the dryer. The preceding wash, dry, and tumble cycle shall be repeated until the entire load has been subjected to five complete wash, dry, and tumble cycles. After completion of the fifth cycle, the test shirts shall be conditioned for 2 hours at 70 (plus or minus 10) degrees Fahrenheit and at a relative humidity of 50 to 65 percent. (Note: During the interruptions between the cycles and during the conditioning and the evaluations, the test shirts shall be placed on wooden or plastic hangers and shall be buttoned at the front.)

4.4.2 Evaluation. After the test shirts have been laundered and conditioned as specified herein, the test shirts shall be evaluated by three trained observers. Each of the trained observers, independent of the other observers, shall evaluate each of the test shirts as follows: The hanger upon which the test shirt has been placed shall be suspended on the viewing board so that the test shirt will lie flat on the surface of the viewing board. The photographic standards for single needle stitching shall be placed on the viewing board. The observer shall stand directly in front but 4 feet from the test shirt. The observer shall then compare the test shirt in each of the areas specified in 3.8 to the photographic standards and shall assign a rating value to each of the specified areas. The rating value assigned to an area by the observer shall be the numerical value of the photographic standard that most nearly matches the area. Seams appearing to fall between the numerical values of the photographic standards may be rated 2.5, 3.5, or 4.5. Each rating value assigned by each of the observers shall be recorded. The average of the three rating values assigned by the three observers to the same area shall be the rating value for that area.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging. Preservation and packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.1.1 Level A. Each shirt shall be folded, in accordance with standard commercial practice, to approximate dimensions of 14 inches in length and 7-1/2 inches in width. The shirt shall be inserted in a bag that is fabricated from 0.0015-inch-thick polyethylene film. All seams and closures of the bag shall be effected by heat sealing (see 5.3.1). A 1/4-inch-diameter hole to allow excess air to escape shall be made in one corner of the bag. Prior to or during the heat-sealing operation, excess air shall be expelled to the extent necessary to insure the required multiples of packaged units will fit into the intermediate containers. As an alternative, the final closure of the bag may be accomplished by a tuck or reverse flap. If the final closure is a tuck or reverse flap, the 1/4-inch-diameter hole will not be required.

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5.1.1.1 Intermediate packages. Six shirts of one size only shall be packaged in a two-piece telescope type setup paperboard box conforming to type II, variety 1, class A, style 4 of PPP-B-676. The outside dimensions of the set-up box (cover included) shall be 14-3/4 inches in length, 7-3/4 inches in width, and 3-11/16 inches in height.

5.1.2 Level C. Shirts shall be packaged in accordance with the Industry's practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Seventy-two shirts of one size only, packaged as specified, shall be packed three in length and four in depth in a fiberboard shipping container, assembled, closed, and reinforced to conform to class weather resistant, size 3 of MIL-B-17757. Toward the end of the contract or if the quantity of shirts of the same size is less than the quantity required per container, mixed sizes (see 5.3.2) may be packed within the same shipping container.

5.2.2 Level B. Seventy-two shirts of one size only, packaged as specified, shall be packed three in length and four in depth in a fiberboard shipping container, assembled and closed to conform to class domestic, size 3 of MIL-B-17757. The container shall be constructed of grade 275 fiberboard. Toward the end of the contract or if the quantity of shirts of the same size is less than the quantity required per container, mixed sizes (see 5.3.2) may be packed within the same shipping container.

5.2.3 Level C. Shirts packaged as specified shall be packed in a manner that will insure acceptance by carriers and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such items. The containers shall be in accordance with the rules of carriers or regulations as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking. Intermediate and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of MIL-STD-129.

5.3.1 Polyethylene packages. Each polyethylene bag (see 5.1.1) shall have the stock number, the nomenclature, the size, and the quantity of the shirts contained therein legibly printed or stamped in black across the center face of the bag, or a white paper label with the required information printed thereon in black shall be placed in the bag so that it is readable through the polyethylene.

5.3.2 Mixed sizes. Each shipping container packed with mixed sizes (see 5.2.1 and 5.2.2) shall have, securely attached to the end and side, white paper labels 5 inches by 4 inches. The words mixed sizes and thereunder the quantity and sizes of shirts in the container shall be legibly printed on each label.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The shirt covered by this specification is intended to be worn by the female personnel of the Department of the Air Force.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification

(b) Sizes required (see 1.1)

(c) Government-furnished standard patterns (see 3.5)

(d) Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2)

6.3 Samples. Color samples and guide samples may be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.

6.4 Figure. Figure 1 shows the general design of the shirt and is for information only.

6.5 Annotation for changes. The margins of this specification are marked with asterisks to indicate where changes from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only, and the Government will assume no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodian:
Air Force - 11

Reviewer:
Air Force - 82

Preparing activity:
Air Force - 11

Project No. 8410-F306

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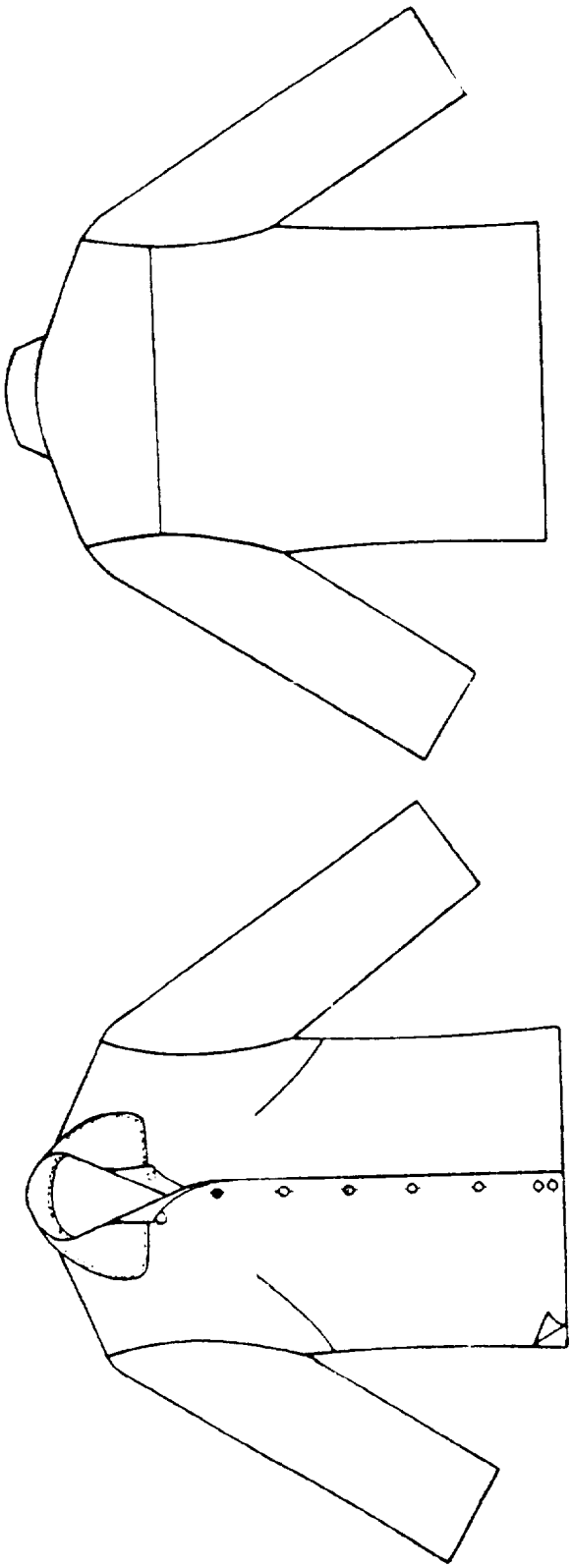


FIGURE 1. Shirt (Front and Rear Views)

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OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

DATE

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